



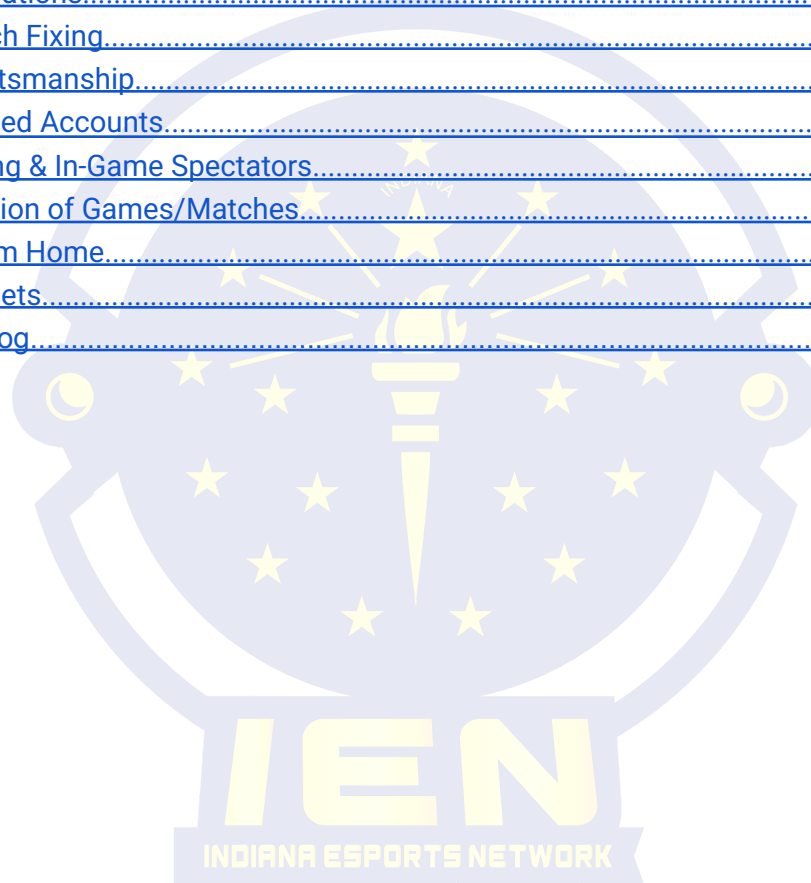
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# Bylaws & General Rules

# Table of Contents

|                                                                                          |                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <a href="#">Table of Contents.....</a>                                                   | <a href="#">2</a>  |
| <a href="#">Organizational Structure.....</a>                                            | <a href="#">6</a>  |
| <a href="#">Mission.....</a>                                                             | <a href="#">6</a>  |
| <a href="#">Vision.....</a>                                                              | <a href="#">6</a>  |
| <a href="#">Purpose.....</a>                                                             | <a href="#">6</a>  |
| <a href="#">Board of Directors.....</a>                                                  | <a href="#">6</a>  |
| <a href="#">Confidentiality.....</a>                                                     | <a href="#">7</a>  |
| <a href="#">Liability.....</a>                                                           | <a href="#">7</a>  |
| <a href="#">Rule Changes.....</a>                                                        | <a href="#">7</a>  |
| <a href="#">Definitions.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">8</a>  |
| <a href="#">Participants.....</a>                                                        | <a href="#">8</a>  |
| <a href="#">Match.....</a>                                                               | <a href="#">9</a>  |
| <a href="#">Structure.....</a>                                                           | <a href="#">9</a>  |
| <a href="#">Penalties.....</a>                                                           | <a href="#">10</a> |
| <a href="#">Roster.....</a>                                                              | <a href="#">10</a> |
| <a href="#">Series Lengths.....</a>                                                      | <a href="#">10</a> |
| <a href="#">Team.....</a>                                                                | <a href="#">11</a> |
| <a href="#">Game Titles.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">12</a> |
| <a href="#">IHSEN Titles.....</a>                                                        | <a href="#">12</a> |
| <a href="#">IMSEN Titles.....</a>                                                        | <a href="#">13</a> |
| <a href="#">Unified Titles.....</a>                                                      | <a href="#">14</a> |
| <a href="#">Varsity/Club.....</a>                                                        | <a href="#">14</a> |
| <a href="#">Eligibility.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">15</a> |
| <a href="#">Player Eligibility For Indiana Esports Network.....</a>                      | <a href="#">15</a> |
| <a href="#">IHSEN School Team Types, Roster Rules, &amp; Postseason Eligibility.....</a> | <a href="#">15</a> |
| <a href="#">IMSEN School Team Types, Roster Rules, &amp; Postseason Eligibility.....</a> | <a href="#">16</a> |
| <a href="#">General Rules.....</a>                                                       | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">Communication.....</a>                                                       | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">Official IEN Communication.....</a>                                          | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">In-Game.....</a>                                                             | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">Out-of-Game.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">Competition.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">17</a> |
| <a href="#">Default Match Time.....</a>                                                  | <a href="#">18</a> |
| <a href="#">Reschedules.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">18</a> |
| <a href="#">Time Zone.....</a>                                                           | <a href="#">18</a> |
| <a href="#">Withdrawals and Forfeits.....</a>                                            | <a href="#">18</a> |
| <a href="#">Equipment &amp; Software.....</a>                                            | <a href="#">19</a> |
| <a href="#">Controllers.....</a>                                                         | <a href="#">19</a> |

|                                                         |                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <a href="#">Drivers &amp; Utilities.....</a>            | <a href="#">19</a> |
| <a href="#">Fair Connection Rule.....</a>               | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Game Modifications.....</a>                 | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Overlays &amp; Tools.....</a>               | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Match Results.....</a>                      | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Incorrect Match Results.....</a>            | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Match Disputes.....</a>                     | <a href="#">20</a> |
| <a href="#">Roster Requirements.....</a>                | <a href="#">21</a> |
| <a href="#">Naming Conventions.....</a>                 | <a href="#">21</a> |
| <a href="#">Rule Violations.....</a>                    | <a href="#">21</a> |
| <a href="#">Match Fixing.....</a>                       | <a href="#">21</a> |
| <a href="#">Sportsmanship.....</a>                      | <a href="#">22</a> |
| <a href="#">Tainted Accounts.....</a>                   | <a href="#">22</a> |
| <a href="#">Streaming &amp; In-Game Spectators.....</a> | <a href="#">22</a> |
| <a href="#">Supervision of Games/Matches.....</a>       | <a href="#">22</a> |
| <a href="#">Play From Home.....</a>                     | <a href="#">23</a> |
| <a href="#">IEN Game Rulesets.....</a>                  | <a href="#">24</a> |
| <a href="#">Changelog.....</a>                          | <a href="#">27</a> |



## Organizational Structure

### Mission

To prepare students for the future through collaboration, communication, creativity, and critical thinking through video games and esports.

### Vision

The vision of IEN is to provide a competitive environment, while focusing on:

- Students are #1- Students are the priority, they are the reason we built our program
- Positivity in the Community – Be a role model for positivity in the gaming community.
- Inclusivity- Gaming is for everyone. All students should feel welcome and valuable.
- Fair Play- Provide consistent rules to keep a level playing field
- Fostering Guidance - Providing a place for students to compete in and learn esports and helping schools build programs

### Purpose

The Indiana Esports Network is a non-profit esports organization composed of public, private, and parochial schools in the State of Indiana. It is the mission of the IEN to do the following:

- Provide an organized esports league for participating schools and school districts (“members”) that offers the structure to be able to schedule regular season and playoff matches between members.
- Offer guidance to member schools regarding the funding and continual improvement of their esports programs.
- Offer an open and inviting environment that is free of judgment and prejudice. Everyone who participates in esports is equally significant. Bringing students of all backgrounds, races, gender, or socioeconomic status together benefits the community.
- To provide opportunities for ALL students to use esports as a platform to acquire critical communication, collaboration, and problem-solving skills needed to thrive in work and in life.

### Board of Directors

The Board of Directors are the official administrators of IEN. They shall meet monthly and be comprised of voluntary staff members appointed by a simple majority vote of existing board members that develop, administer, and revise IEN programming and curriculum for middle school, high school, unified, and community divisions of competition. Board members may step down at any point in time or be removed by a simple majority vote by the rest of the board.



## **Confidentiality**

The content of private information, emails, support tickets, phone calls or any other correspondence with the IEN board of directors and/or administration are deemed as strictly confidential materials. The publication of such material is prohibited without the express written permission from the IEN board of directors.

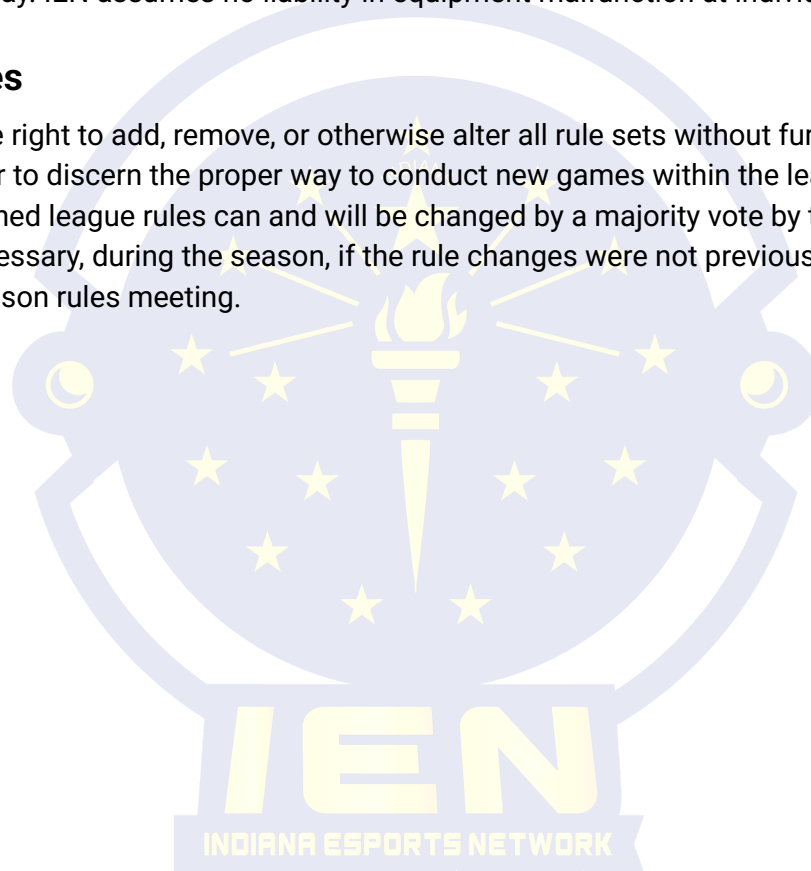
## **Liability**

All participants are expected to know and uphold the rules before and while participating in IEN events (IHSEN, IMSEN, and Unified). Participants will not receive any refunds or compensation for inability to play. IEN assumes no liability in equipment malfunction at individual schools.

## **Rule Changes**

IEN reserves the right to add, remove, or otherwise alter all rule sets without further notice for leagues, in order to discern the proper way to conduct new games within the league.

Already sanctioned league rules can and will be changed by a majority vote by the Board of Directors, if necessary, during the season, if the rule changes were not previously addressed during a pre-season rules meeting.



## Definitions

### Participants

| Term                                   | Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Program Administrator/Advisor/Director | An adult staff member that oversees the esports program/team at a member school or school district. This person is the point of contact for any IEN matters. This person is the point of contact to arrange scrimmages with other schools                                                                                                                               |
| Coach                                  | An adult staff member that oversees the esports program/team at a member school or school district. This person may also be able to help improve their player(s) game performance outside of officially scheduled games or matches. This person may also be the Program Administrator or Program Advisor for their team. This person may also be the contact to arrange |
| Staff Member                           | Any paid or volunteer adult that has been fingerprinted and/or background checked by the individual school who is legally eligible to be around minors according to state law.                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| Captain                                | Any player designated by their school, school district, or team to represent a team in making pre-game or in-game decisions regarding such things as match creation, in-game pauses, or other activities that can occur during a game or match.                                                                                                                         |
| Player                                 | A 6-12 grade student (see "Player Eligibility") that plays competitively against others in a game on a computer, console, or other device.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Unified Athlete                        | An athlete is a student with an intellectual disability who actively participates in training and competition, alongside Unified partners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| Unified Partner                        | A Unified partner is a student without an intellectual disability, who actively participates with the athletes in a fun and meaningful way for training and competition.                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## Match

|                |                                                                                                                                |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Official Match | Any game or “best of” series-of-games that occur during an IEN, IHSEN, or IMSEN scheduled event for official scoring purposes. |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Structure

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Competition               | A competition or competition tournament run by the IEN, IHSEN, IMSEN, or a member school or group, the participants of which are only players belonging to a school or school district on a team with other players from the same school or school district.                       |
| Post-Competition/Playoffs | An elimination bracket following varsity division competition that concludes in a champion.                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Invitational Tournament   | An Invitational tournament (“Invite”) is a tournament run by IHSEN which is made up of participating teams that have been invited to participate, with rules set by IEN, IMSEN, IHSEN, or hosting school.                                                                          |
| Community Open Tournament | An Open tournament (“Opens”) is a tournament run by the IEN, IHSEN, IMSEN, the participants of which may be players that satisfy eligibility requirements. Teams for an Open tournament may contain players that are not currently enrolled in a member school or school district. |
| Season                    | The complete competition schedule includes pre-competition, regular competition, and post-competition. Seasons may conclude at the end of regular competition or post-competition.                                                                                                 |
| Stage/Split               | A division of the season that does not end in post-competition but does carry over standings to the post-competition season. At the conclusion of a split, programs may disband or create new rosters for the next split.                                                          |

## Penalties

Penalties are punishments given to any participant(s) that violate IEN, IMSEN, IHSEN and Unified rules and regulations. Penalties are given on a case-by-case basis at the full discretion of the IEN member(s) assigned to the case. The warning structure may be ignored if the infraction is severe enough to warrant a harsher punishment. Penalties include but are not limited to: match overturns, player/team/school/school district suspension, player/team/school/school district disqualification, or partial/full deduction of prizes. Penalties are not mutually exclusive and may be given in combination at the full discretion of the IEN.

|                        |                                                                                                   |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1st Unofficial warning | Given to coach/sponsor of team                                                                    |
| 1st Official warning   | Team or individual will lose all bans for next match                                              |
| 2nd Official warning   | Team or individual will forfeit next match                                                        |
| 3rd Official warning   | Team or individual will be banned from IEN and its affiliates for 1 Year at the discretion of IEN |

## Roster

|            |                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Roster     | Eligible rosters consist of players from the same school or school district that meet or exceed their school's player eligibility requirements. |
| Starter    | Eligible player that will start a match for their school's roster.                                                                              |
| Substitute | Eligible player that is able to replace a starter between rounds or sets in team titles.                                                        |

## Series Lengths

All matches consist of a series of "games". The series length is the number of games in that match and the amount of games that teams have to play or win for the match to conclude. These are defined as:

| Term      | Definition                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Best of 1 | A best of 1 series consists of one game, the sole winner of that game will determine the winner of the match. Possible scores are 1-0 and 0-1.                        |
| Best of 2 | A best of 2 series consists of two games, a winner can be determined if a 2-0 score is recorded. Another possible score is 1-1, which results in a tie for the match. |

|           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Best of 3 | A best of 3 series consists of a maximum of three games, in which a player/team must win two of those games to win the match. Possible match scores are 2-0, 2-1, 1-2, and 0-2.                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Best of 5 | A best of 5 series consists of a maximum of five games, in which a player/team must win three of those games to win the match. Possible match scores are 3-0, 3-1, 3-2, 2-3, 1-3, and 0-3.                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Best of 7 | A best of 7 series consists of a maximum of seven games, in which a player/team must win four of those games to win the match. Possible match scores are 4-0, 4-1, 4-2, 4-3, 3-4, 2-4, 1-4, and 0-4.                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Home/Away | A home/away series will always consist of two games, in which there is a possibility for players/teams to tie the series with no winner. Possible match scores are 2-0, 1-1, and 0-2. No current game in regular or post season play meets this criteria. Home teams are listed as the second or bottom team and the away team will be the top team or first listed team. |

## Team

|            |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Conference | A group of schools in a Division based on geographical location and proximity. Conferences may not always be geographically correct due to the amount of schools playing a title.                             |
| Division   | A group of schools based on the schools' enrollment numbers.<br>A: 0-500<br>AA: 501-1300<br>AAA: 1301+                                                                                                        |
| Team       | A group of players playing the same video game title on one roster participating in an IEN tournament on behalf of the same school or school district.<br><br>Teams are named after the participating school. |

## Game Titles

Schools will assume that all game titles that IEN offers will only work on the Windows PC operating system platform unless specifically mentioned in parenthesis next to the game title.

Additional game titles will be reviewed every season by the Board of Directors.

Additional game titles may be offered in “one off” community tournaments at the discretion of IEN.

Additional game titles may be added at the discretion of IEN.

Game titles may be removed at the discretion of IEN.

| Term       | Definition                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Team Title | Game titles that consist of 2 teams from different schools facing off against one another directly in a match.                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Solo Title | Game titles that consist of individual entries from several schools competing against each other during preset times.<br><br>Solo titles exist outside the structure of varsity/club & simply allow all IEN members to enroll the maximum amount of registrants per game per school. |

## IHSEN Titles

Games currently offered by the Indiana High School Esports Network

| Title                    | Common Sense Media Review                                                                                                   | Division(s)     | Roster Size         |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|---------------------|
| <a href="#">Valorant</a> | <a href="https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/valorant">https://www.commonsensemedia.org/game-reviews/valorant</a> | Varsity<br>Club | 5 starters   5 subs |
| <a href="#">Chess</a>    | N/A                                                                                                                         | Club+           | unlimited           |
| <a href="#">Tetris</a>   | <a href="https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/tetris-0">https://www.commonsensemedia.org/app-reviews/tetris-0</a>   | Club+           | unlimited           |

|                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                          |              |                     |
|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------|
| <a href="#"><u>Fortnite (Crossplay)</u></a>       | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/fortnite"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/fortnite</u></a>                                   | Varsity Club | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Rocket League (Crossplay)</u></a>  | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league</u></a>                         | Varsity Club | 3 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>iRacing</u></a>                    | N/A                                                                                                                                                                      | Club+        | 5 racers            |
| <a href="#"><u>League of Legends</u></a>          | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/league-of-legends"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/league-of-legends</u></a>                 | Varsity Club | 5 starters   5 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Super Smash Bros. Ultimate</u></a> | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate</u></a> | Varsity Club | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Minecraft</u></a>                  | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/minecraft"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/minecraft</u></a>                                   | Varsity Club | 5 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Overwatch 2 (Crossplay)</u></a>    | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/overwatch-2"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/overwatch-2</u></a>                             | Varsity Club | 5 starters   4 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Mario Kart 8 Deluxe</u></a>        | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe"><u>https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe</u></a>             | Varsity Club | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#"><u>Marvel Rivals (Crossplay)</u></a>  | <a href="https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/"><u>https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/</u></a>                             | Varsity Club | 6 starters   4 subs |

## IMSEN Titles

Games currently offered by the Indiana Middle School Esports Network

| Title                                      | Common Sense Media Review                                                                                                                                         | Division(s)  | Roster Size         |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------|
| <a href="#">Rocket League (Crossplay)</a>  | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league</a>                         | Varsity Club | 3 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Super Smash Bros. Ultimate</a> | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate</a> | Varsity Club | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Fortnite (Crossplay)</a>       | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/fortnite">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/fortnite</a>                                   | Varsity Club | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Minecraft</a>                  | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/minecraft">https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/minecraft</a>                                   | Varsity      | 5 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Mario Kart 8 Deluxe</a>        | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/mario-kart-8-deluxe</a>             | Club         | 4 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Chess</a>                      | N/A                                                                                                                                                               | Club+        | unlimited           |
| <a href="#">Tetris</a>                     | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/tetris-0">https://www.common sense media.org/app-reviews/tetris-0</a>                                     | Club+        | unlimited           |
| <a href="#">Marvel Rivals (Crossplay)</a>  | <a href="https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/">https://www.esrb.org/blog/a-parents-guide-to-marvel-rivals/</a>                             | Varsity Club | 6 starters   4 subs |

## Unified Titles

Games currently offered by IEN as Unified titles

| Title                                      | Common Sense Media Review                                                                                                                                         | Roster Size         |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| <a href="#">Rocket League (Crossplay)</a>  | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/rocket-league</a>                         | 3 starters   2 subs |
| <a href="#">Super Smash Bros. Ultimate</a> | <a href="https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate">https://www.common sense media.org/game-reviews/super-smash-bros-ultimate</a> | 4 starters   2 subs |

This is not to be considered a complete list of all games played, as there may be more in trial stages or at individual schools or school districts.



## Varsity/Club

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Varsity | <p>A school's highest level team in a game or sport. Varsity is the premiere level of competition and leads to postseason and IEN State Finals. Each school may have at most one varsity team per title.</p> <p><b>Each school will be required to pay a \$100 Varsity due per year if they have one or more competing Varsity teams. It is a single fee regardless of the number of Varsity teams and regardless of the number of Splits played. This fee helps support playoff and championship event costs. This fee is due PRIOR to the registration deadline.</b></p> <p><b>Failure to pay will result in penalty at the discretion of the IEN Board.</b></p> |
| Club    | <p>Any school team that wants to take part in competitions but is not considered the Varsity team of the school. Schools may enter multiple teams into Club level but the participants CANNOT be on the Varsity roster for each game or title.</p> <p>Schools can optionally play at Club level and not participate in Varsity.</p> <p>Club+ titles do have a playoff and championship in the spring.</p> <p><b>First semester schools MUST be Club level for one probationary stage/semester.</b></p>                                                                                                                                                             |

## Eligibility

### Player Eligibility For Indiana Esports Network

1. All players must currently be enrolled as a student:
  - a. in high school in Indiana (grades 9-12) for IHSEN and Unified
  - b. in middle school in Indiana (grades 6-8) for IMSEN and Unified
  - c. exceptions to be made at the discretion of the Board of Directors.
2. All players must understand, agree to and sign their program's Code of Conduct.
3. All players must know and adhere to the athletic or esports eligibility guidelines of the school or school district in which they are enrolled.
4. All players must meet or exceed all attendance and academic requirements as practiced by the player's school district.
5. All schools and school districts must be able to provide proof of student enrollment of all players on a team's roster. IHSEN can request the following information about any student:
  - a. Full Name
  - b. Emergency Contact Details
  - c. Date of Birth
  - d. Proof of Enrollment and/or School Records
  - e. Other information as requested

## **IHSEN School Team Types, Roster Rules, & Postseason Eligibility**

1. Schools may have the following types of teams:
  - a. Varsity (Up to one [1] team per title)
  - b. Club (# Up to sponsor's discretion)
2. Schools can optionally play at Club level and not participate in Varsity.
3. New schools joining Indiana High School Esports Network will be required to play at the Club level for 1 stage/semester before moving into Varsity. During this probationary period, if a school has more than 1 forfeit or has any rule violation, they will continue to play at the Club level until there are no violations.
4. Varsity Players
  - Starters & Substitutes listed on the Varsity roster may not play in ANY Club matches unless that player is demoted for the remainder of the split.
    - Teams cannot exceed the Roster Sizes for each of the titles during postseason.
5. Club Players
  - Starters & Substitutes listed on a Club roster may play in the next higher tier of competition.
    - Club players can sub for Varsity matches during the regular season. Club players can be promoted to Varsity roster for the postseason at the time of the postseason roster lock.
    - Club players are automatically promoted to Varsity once they have played in half of the Varsity regular season and are no longer eligible to play Club.

## **IMSEN School Team Types, Roster Rules, & Postseason Eligibility**

1. Schools may have the following types of teams:
  - a. Varsity (Up to one [1] team per title)
  - b. Club (# Up to sponsor's discretion)
2. Schools can optionally play at Club level and not participate in Varsity.
3. New schools joining Indiana Middle School Esports Network will be required to play at the Club level for 1 stage/semester before moving into Varsity. During this probationary period, if a school has more than 1 forfeit or has any rule violation, they will continue to play at the Club level until there are no violations.
4. Varsity Players
  - a. Starters & Substitutes listed on the Varsity roster may not play in ANY Club matches unless that player is demoted for the remainder of the split.
    - i. Teams cannot exceed the Roster Sizes for each of the titles during postseason.
5. Club Players

- Club players can sub for Varsity matches during the regular season. Club players can be promoted to the Varsity roster for the postseason at the time of the postseason roster lock.



## General Rules

### Communication

It is the responsibility of the Coach/Administrator/Advisor to contact their weekly opponent. These methods include but are not limited to LeagueOS Match Chat (preferred), discord, email, and in-game (game lobby) messaging. Teams must provide evidence attempts were made through all possible methods to contact opponents before they will be allowed a forfeit win.

### Official IEN Communication

**All official communication from IEN will occur through Discord. Coaches must have a Discord account and join the IEN Discord server to receive official communication regarding competition, events, potential rule changes, etc. Coaches are also expected to select their roles in the #role-selection channel to ensure they are receiving notices related to their specific responsibilities.**

### In-Game

No chatting will be done in game unless it is to request a pause or a restart. In-game chatting is not allowed unless there is an emergency, such as a fire alarm, tornado warning, or other Act of God.

### Out-of-Game

Players/teams may not have any communication with any outside sources while their official match is in progress. Coaches can communicate with their teams during timeouts and in-between games/matches.

### Competition

Competition - Competition is the designated rounds in which differing rules such as match length, new player/team registration, and match scheduling take place.

- Pre-Season - The preseason stage of a tournament, which may also be referred to as the "Qualifiers" stage, is the stage before a tournament starts where standings/records will not carry over into the regular season.
- Regular Season - The regular season is the main portion of a tournament and composed of one or two stages (semesters) . New teams will not be permitted to enter during this stage (teams may still be changed to add new players during this stage). During this stage, players/teams compete for the highest placements to move on to the postseason.
- Post-Season - The postseason stage of a tournament, which may also be referred to as the "Playoffs" stage, is the single-elimination bracket made up of the highest placing teams from the regular season and seeded accordingly. The initial size of the postseason will depend on the tournament size and number of players/teams actively

participating in the regular stage. Rounds of the postseason may consist of Sectionals (all teams), Regionals (teams advancing from Sectionals ), Quarterfinals (eight teams), Semifinals (four teams) and Finals (two teams). The postseason stage can also include the 3<sup>rd</sup> place match.

- Finals - The finals stage of a tournament is the final match in the previous single-elimination bracket that consists of two teams.

## Default Match Time

**The default match start time for all IMSEN Varsity matches is 3:30 Central time/4:30pm Eastern time. Club Queue times will be at 3:30 Central time/4:30pm Eastern time.**

**The default match start time for all IHSEN Varsity matches is 4:00 Central time/5:00pm Eastern time. Club Queue times will be at 3:00 Central time/4:00pm Eastern time and 4:00 Central time/5:00pm Eastern time. Club teams should join ONE of the queue times on match days.**

## Reschedules

**Regular season Varsity matches should be played at the scheduled time on the scheduled match day. However, matches may be played at any time on the scheduled match day if both teams agree in writing. Matches may never be played on a different day than the scheduled match day unless approved by an IEN official. This may be necessary in the event of an emergency, school closings, etc.**

## Time Zone

The official time zones of IEN are the Eastern Standard Time Zone and Central Standard Time Zone. All official IEN, IMSEN, IHSEN broadcasts, announcements, and web pages will always display time in the Eastern Standard Time Zone with the Central Standard Time Zone listed as well if possible, unless otherwise stated. Tournaments based in a regional time zone will take place in that region's time zone. Any outside play with those of another time zone, must be governed under consent of those playing.

## Withdrawals and Forfeits

In the interest of sportsmanship, we are asking all coaches to talk with their teams and to make sure they understand they will play the full season, even if they have a losing record. This is considered poor sportsmanship by teams if they do not play because of their season records. Any teams that are caught forfeiting matches for these reasons will face possible sanctions.

- Teams that choose to withdraw from a season/tournament during the season will not be allowed to rejoin once the final decision has been made.
- All previous matches by a withdrawn team will stand with the original results.
- Any forfeits made during the remainder of the season will count as a loss for that particular match and will result in an automatic win for their opponent.
- Forfeits include:
  - No shows
  - Miscommunication
  - Insufficient number of players
- Forfeits can be disputed to IEN for consideration if necessary.

## **Forfeit Consequences**

### **Varsity**

- **3 or more forfeits from a single Varsity team during a season split will result in that team's school not being eligible for Varsity play in that game title the following season.**
- **Varsity dues will not be refunded in the event of a forfeiture dismissal.**

### **Club**

- **After 3 or more forfeits, a mandatory meeting with the board will be required before that club team is allowed to queue again.**

## **Equipment & Software**

IEN will not provide any equipment during an online tournament or during playoff matches.

## **Controllers**

Any controllers used in official matches must be the officially licensed controllers for the console in question (excluding accessibility controllers) and cannot be modified in any way. For fighting games, all standard fight sticks and controllers are permitted. Macro or rapid buttons on controllers may not be used.

Controllers may be used for PC games if and only if they meet the requirements above and the game has native support for the controller in question, i.e. the player should not need to install additional software/drivers for the controller other than those from the manufacturer or included with the game.

## **Drivers & Utilities**

Official peripheral drivers for mice, keyboards, headsets, controllers, and other input devices necessary for play are legal. Custom or otherwise 3rd-party software that modifies controls or input is not allowed unless expressly approved by IEN administrators.

### **Approved 3rd-Party Utilities**

- Rawaccel
- Bakkesmod

### **Fair Connection Rule**

IEN is not responsible for any internet issues affecting players/teams. It is the responsibility of the “home” players/teams to come to an agreement with the “visitors” on the server region on which a match will take place. Loss and Choke are not considered valid reasons to change server locations. If the difference in ping is too high, either team may request a server location change or match restart within the first 5 minutes of the match. If teams fail to find a server that falls into the Fair Connection Rule, the home team will choose the server closest to their location.

### **Game Modifications**

Any modification or change to the game done using outside graphics solutions are not permitted and may be considered cheating. Only official skins may be used in-game. Any skin, sprite, GUI, crosshairs, sounds, and models downloaded by a third party are not allowed. Some skins may be banned and will be listed in the individual game rules. Crosshairs may only be edited with the settings in the game. Monitors with built-in crosshair technology are not allowed to be utilized during official matches.

### **Overlays & Tools**

Any 3rd party overlays (as in those that are not included with the game/platform) are prohibited from use in official matches. Usage of 3rd party services to assist in actions such as picks/bans, build guides, or strategies during an official match is strictly prohibited.

### **Match Results**

Matches must be reported by the winning team as soon as possible following the completion of their game. Players/teams are encouraged to document proof of match results if they are needed to verify the legitimacy of a match score report. Match reports must include the match score(s) and all results must be reported no later than 11:59 PM of the default match day. Losses will be awarded for both teams for matches whose scores are not submitted before 11:59 PM on the default match day. If matches are rescheduled results must be reported as soon as the match has been played.

### **Incorrect Match Results**

Reporting incorrect match results will not be tolerated and will be considered cheating. If you report the incorrect results of a match by accident, contact an IEN administrator or the Head Tournament Organizer immediately so they can be fixed.

## Match Disputes

Match disputes may be made at any time before the next week of play. Teams may not dispute matches outside of the current round. Sufficient and undoctored evidence, including but not limited to screenshots, match recordings, or VODs must be submitted per the request of the IEN official(s) handling the match dispute before any decision regarding the dispute will be made. All match disputes must be submitted through the competition platform or directly to a Board of Director.

## Roster Requirements

- Team rosters are to be completed in LeagueOS.
- If, for any reason, the number of players on a roster drops below the minimum number of players needed for a team, the school or school district will be required to withdraw their team for that season unless approval to play with less than the required number has been submitted to IEN administration.
- Teams may only have the allowed number of participants on a roster as stated in the rules of the game they are playing.
- **IHSEN Varsity Players must maintain current game connections on LeagueOS**
  - **Optional for IHSEN Club, IMSEN Varsity & Club, & IUEN Players**

## Naming Conventions

Individual player & team names cannot change over the course of a season unless required by IEN administrators to follow our guidelines.

- Individual Names
  - Should not include anything vulgar or offensive
  - Should not include personally identifiable information (except in the case of iRacing)
- Team Names
  - Team names should include the school, title name and level of play. For example, a Varsity team playing SSBU at MCHS would look like this: **[MCHS] SSBU Varsity**.

## Rule Violations

Violating any of the listed rules in this document, or specific game document(s) will be considered unsportsmanlike. Violations will be handled accordingly, and any step may be skipped depending on the severity of the infraction:

- 1st Unofficial warning. Given to captain/sponsor of team privately
- 1st Official warning: Coaches required meeting with IEN administrators
- 2nd Official warning: Team or individual will forfeit appropriate game/match
- 3rd Official warning: Team or individual will be banned from IEN and its affiliates for 1 Year at the discretion of IEN



## Match Fixing

Match fixing is defined as the act of arranging the outcome of a match prior to it being played. Match fixing is strictly prohibited and all individuals involved will face, at a minimum, a 1 season suspension.

## Sportsmanship

All participants are expected to uphold a universal level of sportsmanship while participating in IEN sanctioned events. Those who fail to behave in a sportsmanlike manner may face penalties at the discretion of IEN administrators.

## Tainted Accounts

At any point during an official match, should a player's game account receive any form of game ban or restriction due to a violation of the game's or the platform that it is played on in terms of service, the match will immediately conclude and a win will be awarded to the team that did not have the offending player. (Subject to Change)

## In-Game Spectators & Streaming

1. Spectators are only permitted in an official match if they meet the following criteria:
  - a. They are spectating solely from their team's side or in-game point of view.
  - b. They are on the coaching staff, a listed substitute for the game, or producing the team's stream.
  - c. They do not communicate with any participants of the streamed match during the duration of the competition outside of technical difficulties.
2. Streaming from Neutral Perspectives (applicable to titles such as Overwatch 2 & Valorant):
  - a. Programs should apply to spectate and stream from the neutral perspective using the following application: [IEN Verified Streaming Application](#)
  - b. Programs that are approved to stream from neutral perspectives can be found on the [IEN Verified Streaming Application \(Responses\) spreadsheet](#).

IEN reserves the right to prohibit spectators of any kind in an official match to preserve competitive integrity.

Each individual game may have its own streaming specifics that takes precedence over these general rules.

## Supervision of Games/Matches

- Any IEN official match will be supervised by at least 1 Program Administrator, Program Advisor, or Coach per team.
- Program Administrators, Program Advisors, and/or Coaches will ensure that no cheating or invalid roster changes are taking place.
- Program Administrators, Program Advisors, and/or Coaches will ensure that players who use vulgar language and/or become toxic during an official match will be punished according to terms outlined in the IHSEN Code of Conduct.
- Program Administrators, Program Advisors, and/or Coaches of both teams will be available for communication with each other during match play

## Play From Home

The intent for all IEN play is for it to occur at team schools under adult supervision. Schools should only compete from home under the following conditions:

- The school is a completely online institution
- The school is currently in the process of building a team lab
- Team lab is unavailable due to renovations for the split/season
- Personal emergencies of individual players

In all other circumstances, we encourage teams to either reschedule within the semester to play the match from their school's facility. Failure to do so will result in one or both teams forfeiting the match.

Students must understand the match dates and that no internet connection issues, equipment issues, etc. can interfere with match day. Schools can loan equipment to students to allow them to play from home. Schools cannot force students to come to the school to play if the school has been closed due to pandemic reasons. Schools cannot force students to purchase equipment for play.

Coaches are expected to be text chatting with the opposing coach in a real time basis as matches are being played, at a minimum. This will allow coaches to interact with each other in real time in case of match problems. Coaches will be respectful to other coaches and other teams during this time.

Matches should start by the default start time UNLESS BOTH coaches agree to a new start time. We want to reiterate this rule to make sure everyone understands it.

Coaches **MUST BE IN COMMUNICATION** with their team during the match. Coaches can spectate from their team colors and on their side only. Any coaches caught spectating matches

and are not spectating from their team color will have sanctions levied against them and their school. This is considered poor sportsmanship and will not be tolerated in IEN.

## **In-Person Hardware/Equipment**

Matches/competitions that are held in-person at official IEN events in which the title is cross-platform will be played on PC. Players must be able to login and authenticate on PC with the appropriate accounts (as linked on the competition platform, and that they have been using for the regular season competition). Basic PC peripherals will be provided when possible, but it is the responsibility of all coaches to ensure that their players have the required and acceptable equipment as outlined in the Equipment and Software section above.



## IEN Game Rulesets

|                                                                                     |                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Chess Rules</a>                                      |
|    | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Fortnite Rules</a>                                   |
|   | <a href="#">IHSEN iRacing Rules</a><br><a href="#">League of Legends 2025-2026</a> |
|  | <a href="#">IHSEN League of Legends Rules</a>                                      |
|  | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Mario Kart Rules</a>                                 |

|                                                                                     |                                                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
|    | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Marvel Rivals Rules</a> |
|    | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Minecraft Rules</a>     |
|   | <a href="#">IHSEN Overwatch 2 Rules</a>               |
|  | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN Rocket League Rules</a> |
|  | <a href="#">IHSEN &amp; IMSEN SSBU Rules</a>          |



[IHSEN & IMSEN Tetris Rules](#)



[Unified Rocket League Rules](#)



[Unified SSBU Rules](#)



[IHSEN Valorant Rules](#)

INDIANA ESPORTS NETWORK

# Changelog

## May 2024

- Addition of varsity payment
- Competition council removed
- Definitions updated
  - Tournament changed to Solo
  - Removal of Academy
- Chess rules updated
- Fortnite Battle Royale updated
- Minecraft updated
- SSBU rules updated
  - Changed from Best of 2 to Best of 3
  - Stage of the Week removed from counterpicks
  - Kalos Pokemon League added to counterpicks
- Tetris rules updated
- Fortnite Zone Wars added
- Mario Kart 8 Deluxe added
- Updated Board of Directors
- Updated Confidentiality
- Updated Liability

## January 2025

- Updated Valorant map pool (patch 10.00)
- CompMC cost increase to \$35.00

## August 2025

- Added clarification about game platforms for IEN in-person events
- Removed title rules section
- Linked individual title rules docs
- Added Marvel Rivals
- Updated Valorant map pool (again)
- Updated Overwatch 2 map rotation
- Changed Mario Kart map selection/ pool
- Changed Fortnite game mods and map codes to reflect new custom maps
- Updated format for chess and Tetris playoffs
- Updated iRacing rules
- Readded Stage of the Week to SSBU Counterpick stage list.

## September 2024

- Updated Fortnite Zone Wars map code, scoring information and rules
- Updated Valorant Map Pool

## November 2025

- Added character restrictions for new and reworked characters (Valorant, Overwatch, Marvel Rivals).
- Added clarification about role swapping to Overwatch rules.

#### January 2026

- Updated Valorant competitive map pool to reflect the update coming on January 7th.
- Changed chess playoffs to Bo3 for semifinals. (Still Bo5 for finals & 3rd place)

#### February 2026

- Changed League of Legends streaming requirements to 3-minute delay in reflection of removal of client-enforced delay.

